

ONLINE HUSTLES SERIES

15 — Facebook & Instagram Ads Management

Meta Ads · Nigeria-first · 2026

Skill-based · High ceiling · Client ad spend + management fee

How to get paid to run Meta (Facebook/Instagram) ads for Nigerian businesses. Covers skill building, client acquisition, pricing models and responsible delivery.

1. What This Hustle Is

You set up, manage and optimise paid advertising campaigns on Facebook and Instagram for clients. The client pays the ad spend directly to Meta; you charge a management fee (flat monthly, percentage of spend, or performance bonus). This is a high-skill, high-ceiling hustle. Results (leads, sales, messages) matter more than vanity metrics.

2. Earnings Reality 2026

Level	Fee model example	Monthly potential	Notes
Beginner	■30k–■80k / client	■50k–■200k	1–3 small clients
Active	■80k–■200k / client	■300k–■800k	3–6 clients
Specialist	% of spend + bonus	■1m–■5m+	E-commerce / high spend

Some Nigerian media buyers report very high monthly income once they manage significant ad spend for e-commerce or lead-gen clients. This only happens after real skill and case studies exist.

3. Skills You Must Build First

- Meta Ads Manager interface (campaign, ad set, ad structure)
- Pixel / Conversions API basic setup understanding
- Audience targeting (interests, lookalikes, retargeting)
- Creative testing (images, videos, copy angles)
- Reading results (CPA, ROAS, CTR, frequency)
- Clear communication of results to non-technical clients

Free learning: Meta Blueprint, YouTube tutorials, practice with a small personal budget if possible.

4. How to Get Clients in Nigeria

- Start with businesses already spending on ads (or clearly needing leads/sales).
- E-commerce stores, real estate, education/courses, local services with high ticket, event promoters.
- Offer a paid audit or a small test campaign rather than free work.
- Showcase case studies (even small personal or friend projects) with real numbers.
- Network with web designers, SMM freelancers and digital agencies who need media buying.

5. Pricing Models That Work

- Flat monthly management fee (simplest for beginners)
- Percentage of ad spend (e.g. 10–20%)
- Base fee + performance bonus
- Project-based (setup + first 30 days)

Always separate your fee from the client's ad spend. Client pays Meta directly.

6. Delivery & Reporting Basics

- Weekly or bi-weekly short report: spend, results, what you changed, next plan.
- Never guarantee specific sales numbers — algorithms and offers vary.
- Focus clients on business outcomes (cost per lead, cost per sale) not just likes.
- Keep creatives fresh; ad fatigue is real.

7. Common Mistakes

- Running ads with no clear offer or landing page.
- Promising “guaranteed” ROAS or sales.
- Scaling spend too fast before creative and audience are proven.
- Taking on clients whose product/offer is fundamentally weak.
- No written scope of work or payment terms.

8. 60–90 Day Skill-to-Client Path

Days 1–30: Learn Meta Ads Manager thoroughly. Run small tests with personal or friend budget if possible. Document everything.

Days 31–60: Create 1–2 case studies. Write clear service packages. Start outreach to 20–30 relevant businesses.

Days 61–90: Secure first 1–2 paying clients. Deliver carefully, report clearly, ask for testimonials and referrals.

9. Action Checklist

- Meta Blueprint or equivalent foundation completed
- Comfortable inside Ads Manager (campaign structure clear)
- At least one documented test or case study
- Service packages and pricing written
- Outreach list of 20+ potential clients prepared